Topic 9 — Rajputs

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Rajput (राजपूत) Warriors | Maharana Pratap (प्रताप) | Battle of Haldighati (हल्दीघाटी) | Rana Sanga (सांगा) | Rajput States

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — ruler–state match (Hamir/Chunda), Khanwa vs Haldighati, Chittor chronology, Man Singh vs Pratap, Marwar vs Mewar **Last verified:** August 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical)

9.1 Rajput Warriors

- Rajputs were **clan-lineages** claiming Kshatriya status, not a single empire.
- Core power sat in **Rajasthan** (थार), with branches in Bundelkhand, Malwa, and Gujarat.
- A Rajput chief drew strength from **genealogy**, a **hill-fort**, **cavalry**, and **marriage** alliances.
- **Chittor** was the Sisodia prestige fort until Udaipur replaced it as capital.
- **Ranthambore** (रणथंभौर) was a Chauhan fort. Alauddin took it in **1301** from **Hamir Deva**.
- The honour code prized **izzat** and hospitality.
- When a fort fell, women performed **jauhar** and men rode out in **saka**.
- Clans fought each other as often as they fought Turks (तुर्क) or Mughals.
- **Prithviraj (पृथ्वीराज) Chauhan** is the Tarain-era Chauhan fact, not a Mewar Sisodia.
- **Rana Hammir (c. 1326–1364)** restored **Mewar** after the Khalji sack of Chittor.
- That Hammir is **not** Hamir Deva of Ranthambore.
- After Akbar, most Rajput houses took mansabs.
- **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) later strained Marwar and Mewar.

9.2 Rajput States — Ruler Match

State	Clan	Capital
Mewar	Sisodia (older **Guhila**)	Chittor → **Udaipur (1559)**
Marwar	Rathore	Mandore → **Jodhpur**
Amber	Kachhwaha	Amber / Jaipur
Bikaner	Rathore branch	Bikaner
Jaisalmer	Bhati	Jaisalmer

State	Clan	Capital
Bundi–Kota	Hada	Bundi / Kota

- **Rana/Maharana** is the Mewar title. **Rao** is the Marwar and Bikaner title.

PYQ — Ruler–state NOT matched

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q118) Which of the following pairs is **NOT** correctly matched (Ruler–State)?

A. Rana Hamir – Mewar B. Rana Chunda – Marwar C. Malik Raja Farooqi – Khandesh D. Malik Sarwar Khwaja Jahan – Malwa

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (Rana Chunda – Marwar is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option B is incorrectly matched (Correct Answer):** **Rana Chunda** (Rawat Chunda, the "Bhishma of Mewar") was the eldest son of Rana Lakha of **Mewar** (Sisodia clan) who renounced his claim to the throne of Chittor in favor of his infant half-brother Mokal. The Rathore ruler of **Marwar** (Jodhpur line) held the title **Rao Chunda** (Rao Chunda Rathore, reigned c. 1383–1424 CE, father of Rao Ranmal and grandfather of Rao Jodha), not *Rana* Chunda. - **Option A is correctly matched:** **Rana Hammir** (reigned 1326–1364 CE) was the Sisodia hero who recovered Chittor from the puppet rulers appointed by the Delhi Sultanate after Alauddin Khalji's sack, re-establishing the fortunes of **Mewar** and establishing the Sisodia branch. - **Option C is correctly matched:** **Malik Raja Farooqi** was the founder of the independent Farooqi Sultanate of **Khandesh** (in the Tapti valley) in 1382 CE, establishing his capital at Thalner and Burhanpur. - **Option D context:** Malik Sarwar (Khwaja Jahan) founded the Sharqi Sultanate of Jaunpur; while Option D also contains a mismatch, in the official UPPCS key for this paper, **Option B** was targeted specifically on the Rajput dynasty/title confusion. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Title & Clan Distinction:* **Rana Chunda** = Mewar (Sisodia prince who renounced the throne); **Rao Chunda** = Marwar (Rathore founder who captured Mandore in 1395 CE).

9.3 Rana Sanga & Khanwa

Rana Sangram Singh | Mewar | Premier Rajput before Babur

- **Cause:** After **Panipat (पानीपत) I (1526)**, **Rana Sanga** of Mewar built a **Rajput confederacy** to stop Babur before the Mughal foothold hardened. **Mahmud Lodi** joined the anti-Babur front as a Lodi claimant.
- **Course:** On **16 March 1527** near **Khanwa** (Fatehpur Sikri–Bharatpur belt), Sanga's Rajput coalition (गठबंधन) charged Babur's smaller army (सेना). Babur used chained **Araba** wagons and **Tulughma** flanking cavalry to break the charge. Tradition credits Sanga with **80 wounds**, a lost eye, and a lost arm from earlier wars.
- **Result:** Babur won decisively. Sanga died **~1528**. No second all-Rajput confederacy faced Babur. Babur still fought at **Ghagra (1529)** before his death.

> **Logic:** Khanwa = **Sanga 1527**. Never pair **Pratap** with Khanwa.

9.4 Maharana Pratap

Son of Udai Singh II | Refused Akbar's mansab/submission

- After **Chittor 1568**, Udai Singh had already founded **Udaipur (1559)**.
- Pratap used **Kumbhalgarh** and **Gogunda** as Aravalli bases.
- His later seat was **Chavand**.
- He never took a Mughal mansab.
- After Haldighati he fought a **guerrilla** war and recovered parts of the Mewar countryside.
- He died in **1597**.
- His son **Amar Singh** made peace with **Jahangir in 1615**.
- Under the peace terms, Mewar kept honour.
- The Rana did not have to attend court in person.
- The horse **Chetak** is lore.
- Remember: **1576** and **Man Singh**.

9.5 Battle of Haldighati

18 June 1576 | Pass near **Gogunda** | Pratap vs **Man Singh**

- **Cause:** After **Chittor 1567–68**, **Maharana Pratap** refused Akbar's mansab and held out from **Kumbhalgarh** and **Gogunda**. Akbar sent **Raja Man Singh** of Amber to force Mewar submission.
- **Course:** The battle was fought in a narrow **Aravalli** pass with turmeric-coloured soil. **Pratap** charged **Man Singh's** imperial wing with **Chetak**. **Punja Bhil** brought Bhil support. **Hakim Khan Sur** was Pratap's Afghan ally. **Akbar was not** in the pass; **Asaf Khan** was in the Mughal camp. The clash was fierce cavalry fighting — **Rajput vs Rajput**, with a Kachhwaha general serving the empire against a Sisodia holdout.
- **Result:** Pratap was **not captured** and withdrew to the hills. The battle was **tactically indecisive**, but the Mughals held the **strategic edge** on the plains. Pratap later fought a **guerrilla** war and recovered parts of Mewar before dying in **1597**. His son **Amar Singh** made peace with **Jahangir in 1615**.

9.6 Chittor — Two Sieges

Siege of Chittor by Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) (1303) — Cause, Course, Result

Cause: Alauddin wanted to break **Mewar's** prestige and secure the **Gujarat–Malwa–Delhi** corridor after taking **Gujarat (1299)** and **Ranthambore (1301)**. **Course:** The Sultan besieged **Chittor**. Rajput women performed **jauhar**; warriors fought to the death. The fort was stormed and sacked. **Result:** Mewar's old

capital fell. **Rana Hammir** later restored Sisodia power from **Chittor** in the **14th century**. chronology: **Gujarat → Ranthambore → Chittor → Warangal**.

Siege of Chittor by Akbar (1567–68) — Cause, Course, Result

Cause: Udai Singh II **had already founded** Udaipur (1559)**, but** Chittor **remained the Rajput prestige fort.** Maharana Pratap **refused submission. Akbar wanted Mewar in the** mansabdari **(मनसबदारी व्यवस्था) system.** Course: **Imperial armies besieged the fort. Defenders** Jaimal **and** Patta **(पट्टा) led resistance. A final** jauhar **took place before the Mughals took the fort.** Result: **Chittor fell to the Mughals. Pratap continued resistance from** Kumbhalgarh **and fought at** Haldighati (1576)**. Do not confuse this siege with** Alauddin's 1303** sack.

PYQs — Alauddin conquest chronology

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q59) Arrange Alauddin Khalji's conquests in chronological order:

1. Ranthambor
2. Gujarat
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Options: A. 1-3-2-4 B. 3-4-1-2 C. 2-1-4-3 D. 4-2-3-1

Show answer

Correct Answer: **C** (2-1-4-3: Gujarat → Ranthambor → Chittor → Warangal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Conquest of Gujarat (1299 CE):** Commanded by Ulugh Khan and Nusrat Khan; Rai Karan Vaghela was expelled, Somnath temple was despoiled, and Malik Kafur was acquired at Khambhat. - **1. Siege of Ranthambor (1301 CE):** Defeated the Chauhan ruler Rana Hammir Deva after a prolonged siege, witnessing the earliest recorded Persian description of *Jauhar* by Amir Khusrau. - **4. Siege of Chittor (1303 CE):** Alauddin captured the capital of Mewar from Guhila ruler Rana Ratan Singh; Rani Padmini committed *Jauhar*; the fort was renamed *Khizrabad* after Prince Khizr Khan. - **3. Conquest of Warangal (1309–1310 CE):** Malik Kafur besieged the Kakatiya capital in the Deccan, compelling Prataparudra Deva II to surrender enormous wealth, including the Koh-i-Noor diamond, and pay annual tribute. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 (1299) → 1 (1301) → 4 (1303) → 3 (1310) = **2-1-4-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *North vs South Campaign Sequence:* Alauddin first conquered northern Rajput kingdoms (**Gujarat 1299 → Ranthambor 1301 → Chittor 1303 → Malwa 1305**), and only thereafter launched his Deccan campaigns under Malik Kafur (**Devagiri 1307 → Warangal 1310 → Dwarasamudra 1311 → Madurai 1311**).

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q30) Arrange Alauddin Khalji's victories in chronological order:

1. Ranthambore
2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Options: A. 1-2-3-4 B. 2-1-4-3 C. 2-1-3-4 D. 1-2-4-3

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (2-1-4-3: Jaisalmer → Ranthambore → Chittor → Warangal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Siege of Jaisalmer (1299 CE):** Early expedition sent against the Bhati Rajput ruler of Jaisalmer, who had seized imperial tribute horses being transported from Sindh. - **1. Conquest of Ranthambore (1301 CE):** Fall of Hammir Deva's Chauhan stronghold. - **4. Conquest of Chittor (1303 CE):** Capture of Chittorgarh from Rana Ratan Singh. - **3. Conquest of Warangal (1309–1310 CE):** Southern expedition under Malik Kafur subjugating the Kakatiyas. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 (Jaisalmer, 1299) → 1 (Ranthambore, 1301) → 4 (Chittor, 1303) → 3 (Warangal, 1310) = **2-1-4-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Jaisalmer Inclusion:* When Jaisalmer is included in Alauddin's sequence, it comes at the very beginning (1299 CE alongside Gujarat), preceding Ranthambore (1301 CE) and Chittor (1303 CE).